



In the SME segment, 'cost-effective' is the keyword... The technology is there, and it is possible to give them the service

Kunal Ramteke
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specific enterprise applications and databases. This means customised content pertinent to the client's operations or services can be displayed as menu items or otherwise as SIM items.

The Corporate Directory Service, provided across the board by all operators, provides access to the organisation's Telephone Book and group messaging facility to mobile executives.

This lets executives view other intra-office users in real-time, based on name, group, location (city) or organisation hierarchy, and send SMSes or e-mails to all or selected users. This means that the time delay for locating and communicating within an organisation is significantly reduced.

Not Just The Routine

All this leaves a client with an embarrassment of choices. Other than a clutch of standardised services, each service provider has its own unique selling point for various services. Reliance, for instance, provides solutions for large and medium corporate entities with services such as Wireless Vehicle Tracking Systems and Wireless Lottery Terminals, which use its optical fibre backbone. Orange provides Outlook on GPRS-enabled mobiles and PDAs, as does AirTel.

Options such as closed user group SMS and information services come in different flavours from different service providers. They can be moulded to the needs of every individual business.

Speciality Communication

"I need to download presentations and Excel files from my server at office. All I need to do is connect through my PDA phone—I do not need a laptop,"

says Doshi. "It has a huge effect on productivity—it dramatically cuts down on response time."

"SMEs look at how devices can increase productivity. It is a slightly more demanding segment than the full-fledged corporate segment. Here, 'cost-effective' is the keyword. However, services depend on the demand. The technology is there, and it is possible to give them the service," says Kunal Ramteke, marketing controller, BPL Mobile.

All service providers agree that the focus of the user segment is value for money and productivity enhancement. As far as revenue is concerned, the corporate segment is important on a different plane—brand equity.

Harit Nagpal, chief marketing officer, Hutch, says, "Wireless corporate solutions is one such category of services that would be particularly helpful to boost the productivity of corporate executives by providing them access to information while on the move, any time of the day. Wireless corporate solutions are extremely relevant for this segment of mobile users, and thus form an important part of our service portfolio."

Towards A Perfectly Oiled Machine

Technology is an enabler, and to be perfect, it needs to be invisible. Corporate mobile services, fit this bill perfectly—they work discreetly in the background; they ensure that no one is ever left alone, out there, in the dark. Whether it is data, feedback, or plain keeping in touch, these invisible tendrils keep a business perpetually on-line, literally, while filling in the blank spaces of the corporate jigsaw. ■

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